

STUDY DESIGN · BERTONE ET AL. · AVMA VCT #26005934

How the study was built. Why vets can trust the numbers.

The design, population, and comparator arm behind the equicenta® CTM (eCTM) clinical trial.

138

horses enrolled

195

conditions treated

8

U.S. practices

11

study veterinarians

26 wk

follow-up duration

Design & allocation

Prospective, multicenter, open-label controlled trial across 8 U.S. specialty equine practices (Oct 2024–Aug 2025). Quasi-randomized within practice by coin-toss plus block allocation (TTC / TCT / CTT) targeting ~2:1; a 1.9:1 eCTM-to-standard-of-care ratio was achieved. Conducted and reported under CONSORT 2025 guidance with a pre-specified superiority framework.

Two arms, real-world comparator

eCTM: 91 horses / 128 conditions — a single 1.5 mL intra-articular injection, thawed from –80°C. Standard of care: 47 horses / 67 conditions — clinician-selected biologics (APS, PRP, ACS/IRAP, HA, and others) per veterinary judgment, reflecting how biologics are actually used.

Balanced, well-matched population

No significant differences between arms in breed, age, sex, body weight, discipline, or limb (mean age 8.7 yr; mean 490 kg). Breeds spanned Thoroughbred (40%), Quarter Horse (25%), and Warmblood (25%); disciplines spanned racing, western, eventing/hunter-jumper, and dressage — confirming fair enrollment.

Full spectrum of MSK conditions

All 195 musculoskeletal conditions were enrolled across five diagnostic categories: OA / arthritis / synovitis, tendonitis (SDFT, DDFT), desmitis (suspensory branch, proximal suspensory), OCD, and subchondral bone / cysts — with balanced distribution between arms. eCTM was evaluated across this entire spectrum, not a single condition type.

A challenging, pre-treated cohort

Over half of horses in both arms had prior veterinarian-prescribed biologic therapy (APS, PRP, HA, ACS, amnion, stem cells, A2M) before enrollment — a tough, real-world population that had already needed care, balanced across arms for a fair comparison.

Follow-up that stands up to review

100% completion at the 12-week primary endpoint (138 horses / 195 conditions) and 98% at 26 weeks (3 deaths, unrelated to treatment). Clinical analyses were based on 195 conditions; safety on all 224 injections. First significance for pain and swelling by week 2, lameness by week 4, all clinical outcomes by week 12.

What the standard-of-care arm actually was (76 injections)

67% of standard-of-care injections were autologous blood-derived therapies — the products eCTM was measured against, head-to-head.

36.8% APS

15.8% ACS / IRAP

9.2% PRP

5.3% A2M

7.9% Birth-tissue allograft

6.6% Hyaluronic acid

6.6% Stem cell (BMAC/adipose)

11.8% Other / non-inject.

A design vets ask about — built to be examined, not just cited.

Balanced enrollment, a real-world comparator arm, near-complete follow-up, and independent, blinded analysis.

Equine Performance Labs